

EMPATHY

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Empathy is the ability to emotionally understand what other people feel, see things from their point of view, and imagine yourself in their place. Essentially, it is putting yourself in someone else's position and feeling what they are feeling.

[verywellmind.com](https://www.verywellmind.com)



“It is the action of understanding, being aware of, being sensitive to, and vicariously experiencing the feelings, thoughts, and experience of another.”

Merriam-Webster

DEFINITIONS

For example, in one recent validation of this test, women could correctly read 76% of emotions expressed through eyes, men 71%).

A lack of consumer-centricity costs brands 69 points in NPS (experience rating). 75% of brands audited believed they were consumer-centric, but only 30% of their consumers agreed.

Women are (usually) more empathic. In a UK validation of the EQ with 1716 participants, women were found to have an average EQ of 48/80 (60%), and men 39/80 (49%), indicating that women are 11% more empathic than men.

Empathy levels may be falling. Our ability to empathise with others may be falling according a meta-analysis of US citizen empathy test scores conducted over the past 30 years. The study found that average American today is less empathic than 75% of Americans 30 years ago.

STATISTICS ON EMPATHY

Of 61,000 SKUs representing more than 12,000 new launches since 2011. 3 in 4 FMCG launches fail within a year. Those that succeed focus on “walking in the shoes of the consumer to uncover key demand-driven insights”.

EMPATHY IS NUMBER
ONE RULE FOR “NEW
PRODUCT
INNOVATION
SUCCESS”
THE NIELSEN BREAKTHROUGH
INNOVATION REPORT

A Korean study in the healthcare sector found that empathy improves patient satisfaction and compliance (adhering to treatment schedule). Five hundred and fifty outpatients participated in the study. Physician empathy levels were linked to better information exchange, perceived expertise, interpersonal trust, and partnership. This resulted in higher patient satisfaction and better compliance.

**EMPATHY
IMPROVES
SATISFACTION**

**SUNG, STAN AND MARK.
2004**

It might seem self-evident that the ability to see things from the other side of a negotiating table is beneficial in negotiations, but an INSEAD Experiment by Adam Galinsky and colleagues validated this scientifically. 146 negotiators were profiled for the empathic ability of perspective-taking, and this was found to predict negotiation success. Across three negotiations, empathic perspective-taking was linked to negotiators' ability to discover hidden agreements, to both create and claim resources at the negotiation table.

**EMPATHY
IMPROVES ABILITY
TO NEGOTIATE.**

INSEAD

Empathy was found to be the top competence for good leadership and one of the three strongest predictors of senior executive effectiveness.

Similar results were found by 2016 CCI analysis of 6,731 leaders from 38 countries, where enhanced empathy was linked to superior performance.

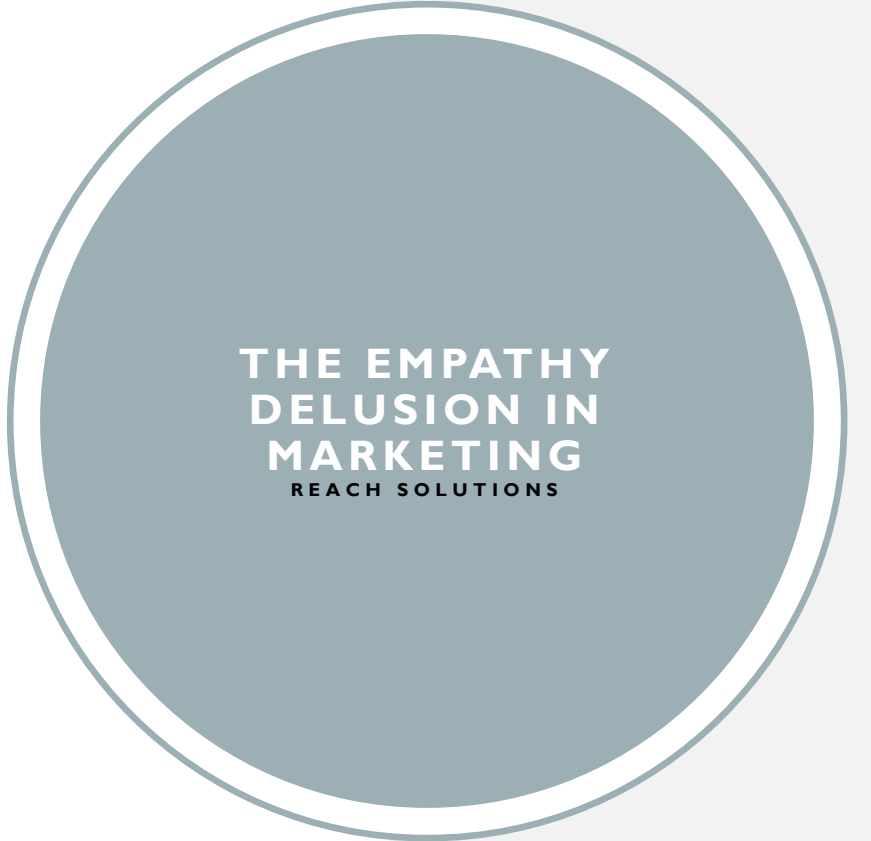
A recent DDI analysis of high performing leadership with 15,000 business leaders confirmed the same link between empathy and leadership performance.

More worrying was the finding that empathy remains low in business leaders, with only 40% having proficient empathy skills.



EMPATHY IS
LINKED TO GOOD
LEADERSHIP
MANAGEMENT RESEARCH GROUP

199 marketing executives completed an empathy psychometric test (the IRI – Interpersonal Reactivity Index) measuring their empathy levels both cognitively and emotionally. The study found no differences between marketers and the general population. Only 30% of marketers were proficient in experiencing the world from someone else's (i.e., the consumer's) perspective.

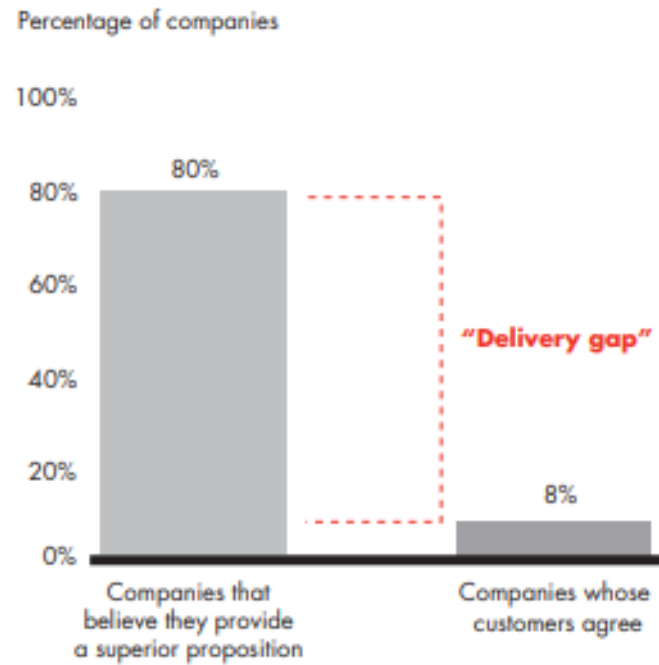


**THE EMPATHY
DELUSION IN
MARKETING**
REACH SOLUTIONS

By assessing whether people's actual real-live experiences of brands matched marketing promises made by the brand.

They found that 18% of customers had stopped using a brand in the past 12 months because of the gap between marketing and experience. 32% believed the gap was overwhelming. The gap represents a fundamental empathy deficit among brands who are out of touch with what it feels like to use the brand.

**THE EMPATHY
DEFICIT IN
BUSINESS COSTS
THE AVERAGE
BRAND OVER
\$300M LOST IN
REVENUE EVERY
YEAR**
M&C SAATCHI



Source: Bain Customer-Led Growth diagnostic questionnaire, n = 362;
Satmetrix Net Promoter database, n = 375

THE EMPATHY DEFICIT AND THE 80:8 RULE.

BAIN AND COMPANY

HOW EMPATHY
CONTRIBUTES TO
POSITIVE OUTCOMES
(FORBES)

Innovation

Of people who reported that their leaders were empathetic, 61% of employees reported that their leaders were most likely to be innovative.

Retention

57% of white women and 62% of women of color said they were unlikely to think of leaving their companies when they felt their life circumstances were respected and valued by their companies. However, when they didn't feel that level of value or respect for their life circumstances, only 14% and 30% of white women and women of color respectively said they were unlikely to consider leaving.

Inclusivity

50% of people with empathetic leaders reported their workplace was inclusive, compared with only 17% of those with less empathetic leadership.

Work-Life

When people felt their leaders were more empathetic, 86% reported they are able to navigate the demands of their work and life—successfully juggling their personal, family and work obligations. This is compared with 60% of those who perceived less empathy.

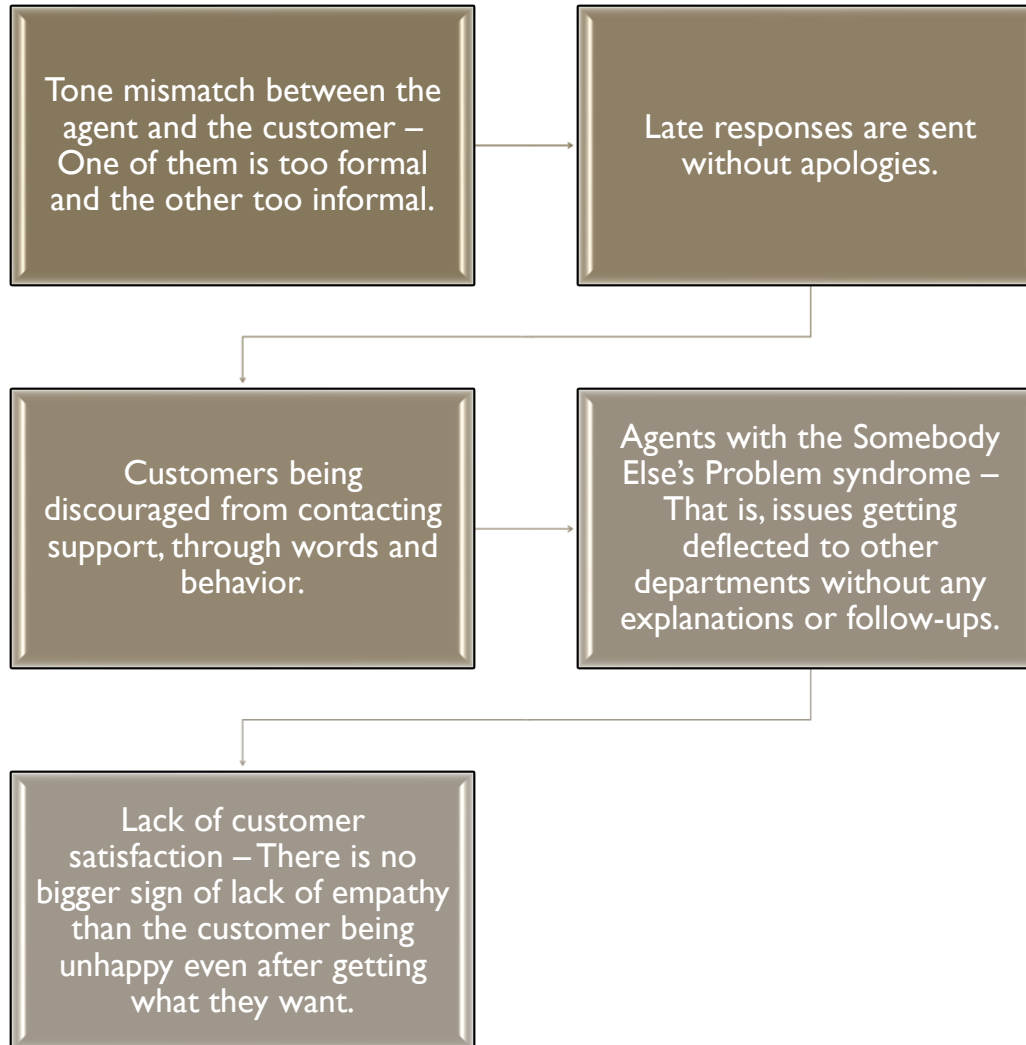
EMPATHY IN CUSTOMER SERVICE

In customer service, empathy is the ability to have a human interaction with a customer where you would intentionally put yourself in the customer's shoes to understand their issue and find the best possible solution for your customers. Let's look at an example of empathy in customer service for a better understanding.



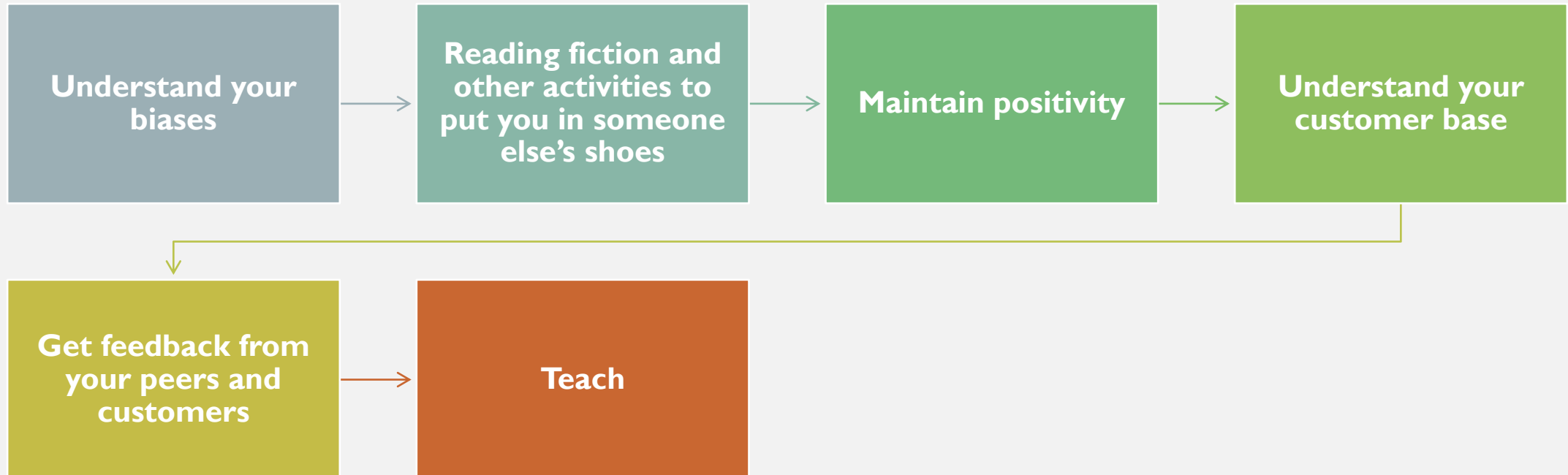


WHY IS EMPATHY
IMPORTANT IN
CUSTOMER SERVICE?



IDENTIFYING AN EMPATHY PROBLEM

HOW TO BUILD EMPATHY?



PRACTICAL WAYS TO EMPATHIZE WITH A CUSTOMER

Active listening

Avoid
sympathy

Keep your
attitude in
check

Give people the
benefit of doubt

Make customers
a part of the
solution

Be curious
about your
customer

Look for
common
interests

Always be
respectful

Be extra careful
when there is a
language
barrier

Respond to the
customer's
tone

Do not assume,
ask

Take their side
when they are
right



7 POWERFUL EMPATHY STATEMENTS

1. "Thank you for bringing this to our attention"
2. "I understand how you feel"
3. "Please let me know if my understanding of your problem is accurate - "
4. "I'm sorry you're facing this issue"
5. "I would do the same if I were in your position too"
6. "Your anger/frustration is completely justified"
7. "Here's what you can do -"

THANK YOU FOR LISTENING